

VS Code AutoDebug Setup Guide

Replication steps for Kiosk-style automated Python debugging environments.

Step 1: Initial Setup & File Migration

- Install **Visual Studio Code** and **Python** on the new machine.
- Copy your project workspace (e.g., `Gen20psConsole`) to the new machine. Make note of its new file path.

Step 2: Create the "AutoDebug" Profile

- Open VS Code on the new machine.
- Click the **Manage (Gear) Icon** in the bottom-left corner > **Profiles** > **Create Profile...**
- Name the profile `AutoDebug` and give it a distinctive icon/badge (like **AU**).
- VS Code will automatically switch to this new profile.

Step 3: Install Required Extensions

While the `AutoDebug` profile is active (check for the AU badge on the gear), open the Extensions tab and install:

- **Python** (by Microsoft) - Required for the debugger to work.
- **Auto Run Command** (e.g., by *gabrielbb*) - The extension responsible for pressing F5 automatically.

Step 4: Configure the Profile's "Auto Run" Settings

We need to instruct the profile to start the debugger immediately after it finishes loading.

- Press **Ctrl + Shift + P**, type **Open Profile Settings (JSON)**, and hit Enter.
- Paste the following JSON configuration:

```
{
  "auto-run-command.rules": [
    {
      "command": "workbench.action.debug.start",
      "event": "onStartupFinished"
    }
  ],
  "workbench.startupEditor": "none"
}
```

Step 5: Define Launch Arguments (launch.json)

Define how the target Python script should run and pass your command-line arguments here.

- Open your project folder/workspace in VS Code.
- Edit your **.vscode/launch.json** file to target your master script:

```
{
  "version": "0.2.0",
  "configurations": [
    {
      "name": "Gen20psConsole_Debug",
      "type": "debugpy",
      "request": "launch",
      "program": "${workspaceFolder}/MasterControl.py",
      "console": "integratedTerminal",
      "args": ["--arg1", "value1", "--arg2"]
    }
  ]
}
```

Step 6: Configure Windows Autostart (shell:startup)

Finally, set Windows to launch this specific workspace and profile when the user logs in.

- Press **Win + R**, type **shell:startup**, and press Enter.
- Right-click empty space in the folder > **New > Shortcut**.
- Paste your exact command line as the target (update the username/paths to match the new PC if different):

```
"C:\Users\NewUser\AppData\Local\Programs\Microsoft VS Code\Code.exe" "C:\Users\NewUser\Documents\Software\Gen20psConsole\Gen20psConsole.code-workspace" --new-window --profile "AutoDebug"
```